OYINLOLA LAWAL

APPLICATION SECURITY · DEVSECOPS

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SUMMARY

Software engineer moving into application security, with three years building the production systems security teams are asked to review. I designed and shipped a CI/CD security pipeline (Semgrep, Trivy, Gitleaks) into a live multi-tenant SaaS product, clearing 104 production dependency vulnerabilities and 15 secrets from full git history, and caught a deploy gate that read a cancelled scan as a pass. Reading the code by hand found three production bypasses no scanner reported. I then measured a ModSecurity WAF against a no-WAF control and showed that the attack deciding a breach, broken object-level authorisation, is stopped by the application's tenant isolation, not the WAF.

SKILLS

Secure SDLC: security requirements, threat modelling (PASTA, STRIDE, data-flow diagrams, attack trees), secure design review, secure code review, CI security gates, severity policy and triage

SAST, SCA and secrets: Semgrep, Trivy, Dependabot, pnpm/npm audit, reachability triage, Gitleaks full-history scanning, SHA-pinned GitHub Actions, script-injection hardening

Dynamic testing: payload testing against a control, ModSecurity and OWASP CRS tuning and virtual patching, Burp Suite

Identity and access: RBAC and least privilege, multi-tenant isolation, BOLA/IDOR, OAuth2/OIDC, JWT, rate limiting and lockout, scoped revocable tokens, webhook signature verification

AI security: prompt injection, tool-call authorisation, abuse and cost controls on AI endpoints, OWASP LLM Top 10

Engineering: TypeScript, Next.js, React, NestJS, Prisma, MySQL, Docker, NGINX, Linux, GitHub Actions, Python, Bash

Standards: OWASP Top 10, OWASP ASVS 5.0, NIST CSF, NIST SP 800-30

Collaboration: explaining findings to non-technical leaders by impact, likelihood and cost; team leadership, code review, technical writing

EXPERIENCE

SafulPay | Freetown, Sierra Leone

Software Engineer, Frontend · Feb 2024 to Present

Digital payments platform with 10,000+ users and 1,300+ agents on iOS and Android.

- Rejected malformed input before it reached the payments API by validating every onboarding and dashboard form with Zod and React Hook Form at the client trust boundary.
- Led and built the agency banking dashboard used to onboard and verify agents and merchants, with KYC document capture and role-scoped views, supporting a network of 1,300+ agents.
- Engineered the v2 frontend architecture in React and TypeScript with the Go backend team, covering API contracts and authenticated session handling.
- Escaped JSON-LD output on the corporate site to close an XSS path while re-platforming it to Next.js, which raised Lighthouse from 68 to 100.

Tech N' Goodwill Limited | Freetown, Sierra Leone

Software Engineer and Team Lead (Application Security) · May 2023 to Present

Software company of 25 staff. Builds Trakkam, a multi-tenant GPS fleet SaaS (trakkam.com).

- Took Trakkam's production dependency vulnerabilities from 104 to 0, secrets across full git history from 15 to 0 and SAST findings from 8 to 1 documented false positive, by adding Semgrep, Trivy and Gitleaks to CI on pull request, push and a weekly schedule without disturbing existing workflows.

- Caught the deploy gate failing open days after building it, because a cancelled scan was read as a pass, and rewrote it to require explicit success. Set blocking policy from a measured baseline so the pipeline stayed on instead of failing every pull request.
- Found a live webhook credential in logs and history while baselining, rotated it, then reviewed the code by hand and found three development bypasses gated on a request header, all live in production and none reported by any scanner.
- Fixed 11 security issues in one hardening pass, including an XSS sink in map popups, timing-unsafe CSRF checks, Google sign-in tokens accepted without an issuer check, and an account-takeover path in Google account linking.
- Designed the 7-tier role model and organisation-scoped data that enforce tenant isolation over live location data, and lead the 6-person engineering and IT team, explaining security findings to leaders by impact, likelihood and cost.

Nimble Capital Limited | Abeokuta, Nigeria

IT Specialist · Feb 2021 to Dec 2022

- Ran day-to-day technical operations, keeping systems up and supporting staff across endpoints and internal tools.

PROJECTS AND SECURITY LABS

WAF Runtime Defence | lawaloyinlola.com/security/labs

- ModSecurity and OWASP CRS 4 measured across eight phases against a control. 14 of 20 attacks stopped with 0 of 9 false positives at tuned paranoia level 1, 15 with a virtual patch.

CI/CD Security Pipeline | lawaloyinlola.com/security/labs

- The Trakkam pipeline rebuilt as a public guide on OWASP Juice Shop, with every finding triaged to a fix, a dated acceptance or a reasoned false positive, and a public fork proving the gate refuses anything but success.

appsec-protocols | github.com/lawalOyinlola/appsec-protocols

- 82 security, legal and kickoff controls as agent skills for AI coding agents, each with one executable check, enforced in CI and mapped to OWASP ASVS 5.0.

Writing and case studies | lawaloyinlola.com/blog · github.com/lawalOyinlola/cybersecurity-portfolio

- Posts on prompt injection as an authority problem, coding-agent supply chain and what a WAF actually blocks, plus a PASTA threat model and a NIST SP 800-30 risk assessment in Context, Action, Result form.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate, Google via Coursera, Jul 2026.
- TryHackMe Cyber Security 101 and Pre Security learning paths, Sep 2026.
- HNG 12 Internship, Frontend Track Finalist, top 432 of 11,285 participants, Apr 2025.
- In progress: TryHackMe Security Engineer path, CompTIA Security+, then Microsoft SC-300.

EDUCATION

- **Higher Diploma in Science in Computing (NFQ Level 8)**, Griffith College, Dublin, Ireland · admitted, Feb 2027 to Feb 2028
- **Diploma in Frontend Engineering**, AltSchool Africa, Lagos, Nigeria · Mar 2023 to Feb 2024 · 95/100
- **BSc Animal Nutrition**, Federal University of Agriculture, Abeokuta, Nigeria · Sep 2016 to Oct 2021